

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Ruler chronology and turning points

c. 850 -> Vijayalaya secures Tanjavur and a lower-Kaveri foothold
949 -> Takkolam marks a major setback under Parantaka I
985-1014 -> Rajaraja I expands, surveys and builds Brihadisvara
1012-1044 -> Rajendra I; Gangaikondacholapuram and 1025 expedition
1070 onward -> Kulottunga I links Chola and Eastern Chalukya lines
13th c. -> Pandya resurgence and other pressures end imperial primacy.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Political geography as zones

DIRECT CORE -> lower Kaveri delta, Tanjavur and royal-temple centres

ANNEXED ZONES -> Tondaimandalam and changing southern territories

CONTESTED BELTS -> Pandya, Chera and western Deccan frontiers

DYNASTIC HINGE -> Vengi and Eastern Chalukya marriage politics

ISLAND CONTROL -> stronger and longer in northern Sri Lanka

MARITIME ARC -> Maldives and Srivijaya targets; not mainland-style provinces.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Kaveri ecology to imperial capacity

KAVERI WATER + DELTA SOILS

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tanks, channels, bunds and coordinated irrigation

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wet-rice surplus + dense settlement + taxable agrarian base

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temples, armies, officials and monumental building

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imperial projection inland and across the Bay of Bengal

LIMIT: ecology enabled power; institutions and coercion organised it.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: State hierarchy and local institutions

KING / COURT -> royal orders + war + survey + revenue + temple patronage

MANDALAM -> VALANADU -> NADU / KURRAM, with regional and chronological variation

LOCAL BODIES -> ur + brahmadeya sabha/mahasabha + merchant nagaram

COMMITTEES -> variyam for specified work; not one empire-wide template

INTERMEDIARIES -> officers + chiefs + temples + landed and corporate elites

VERDICT: royal capacity and local institutions interacted unequally.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Uttaramerur without the democracy myth

ELIGIBLE LOCAL NOTABLES -> qualifications and disqualifications

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WARD NOMINATIONS -> names placed on tickets

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KUDAVOLAI -> pot-ticket selection for committees

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COMMITTEE SERVICE -> rotation, accounts and removal rules

SECURE CLAIM: sophisticated sabha procedure

LIMIT: restricted Brahmadeya participation, not universal adult franchise.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Land, revenue and social differentiation

LAND RIGHTS -> ownership + cultivation + revenue + jurisdiction can differ

REVENUE -> survey + assessment + taxes + dues + labour and remission

POWER -> vellala groups + Brahmana bodies + temples + royal agents

PRODUCTION -> peasants + artisans + herders + service communities

EXCLUSION -> segregated settlements and dependent or servile relations

GENDER -> elite and temple women are visible; ordinary labour is under-recorded

LIMIT: inscriptional category is not a uniform social condition.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Temple, monument and institutional power

BRIHADISVARA / OTHER GREAT TEMPLES

- |-- royal ideology and public monumentality
- |-- endowed land, lamps, food and ritual services
- |-- employment for specialists, artisans and performers
- |-- inscriptions recording donors, taxes and institutional decisions
- `-- living worship across later political periods

RULE: read architecture together with surplus, labour and authority.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Bronzes, religion and language

LOST-WAX CASTING -> individually modelled processional icons

NATARAJA -> theology, movement, ritual use and technical mastery

SHAIVA BHAKTI -> temple liturgy and Nayanmar memory

VAISHNAVA / BUDDHIST / JAINA -> plural but uneven institutional presence

TAMIL + SANSKRIT -> bilingual political, devotional and learned culture

PROVENANCE RULE -> an art object also has a temple and ownership history.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Guilds, ports and Bay of Bengal exchange

KAVERI HINTERLAND -> produce, textiles, metalwork and temple demand

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NAGAPATTINAM + OTHER PORTS

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merchant bodies: Ayyavole / Manigramam / Anjuvannam

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SRI LANKA -> MALDIVES -> STRAITS -> SOUTHEAST ASIA -> CHINA

MONSOON + SHIPPING + CREDIT + DIPLOMACY sustain movement

LIMIT: trade networks were not simply state-owned fleets.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Sri Lanka and Srivijaya: coercion with limits

SRI LANKA

territorial conquest

provincial administration

long resistance and reconquest

stronger northern control

COMMON POINT -> maritime logistics and royal coercive capacity

CAUTION -> expeditionary success != permanent oceanic empire.

SRIVIJAYA, 1025

rapid strike on linked centres

no durable mainland-style province

commercial-strategic signalling

target list from Chola inscription

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: How historians model the Chola state

CENTRALISED VIEW -> strong monarchy, hierarchy, survey and taxation

BURTON STEIN -> segmentary state and ritually radiating sovereignty

KARASHIMA / SUBBARAYALU -> inscription-led locality, land and social analysis

NEGOTIATED MODEL -> royal force + temple + nadu + sabha + local elites

BEST USE -> compare evidence by region and reign

VERDICT: neither perfect bureaucracy nor autonomous village republic.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Decline, legacy and answer spine

CAUSES -> succession strains + frontier wars + Pandya resurgence

+ Hoysala pressure + locality and resource shifts

END OF EMPIRE != end of temples, irrigation, Tamil culture or trade

OPEN -> Kaveri-centred agrarian-imperial-commercial formation

BODY -> state/locality + economy/society + temple/culture + maritime reach

QUALIFY -> inscriptions are elite; sea power was selective

CLOSE -> durable regional institutions outlasted imperial primacy.